Yanlin Qu

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Employment

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen — Shenzhen, China
Tenure-Track Assistant Professor in the School of Data Science — 2026
Area: Operations Research

Columbia Business School — NY, USA
Postdoctoral Researcher in the Decision, Risk, and Operations Division — 2024 - 2026
Mentors: Assaf Zeevi and Hongseok Namkoong

Education

Stanford University — CA, USA
PhD in Management Science and Engineering — 2018 - 2024
Advisors: Peter Glynn and Jose Blanchet

University of Science and Technology of China — Anhui, China
BSc in Mathematics and Applied Mathematics — 2014 - 2018
Area: Probability and Statistics

Research Interests

Applied Probability

Markov Chains and Processes

Multi-Armed Bandits

Stochastic Simulation

Publications

Y. Qu, H. Namkoong, and A. Zeevi. What Does Thompson Sampling Optimize? ICML 2026.

Y. Qu, J. Blanchet, and P. Glynn. Deep Learning for Markov Chains: Lyapunov Functions, Poisson's Equation, and Stationary Distributions. *Queueing Systems*, arXiv, 2026.

- Special Issue: 40 Years of QUESTA
- NeurIPS 2025 Workshop MLxOR

Y. Qu, J. Blanchet, and P. Glynn. Computable Bounds on Convergence of Markov Chains in Wasserstein Distance via Contractive Drift. *Annals of Applied Probability*, arXiv, 2025.

- Applied Probability Society Best Student Paper Prize, 2023
- Applied Probability Society Conference Best Poster Award, 2023

Y. Qu, J. Blanchet, and P. Glynn. Deep Learning for Computing Convergence Rates of Markov Chains. NeurIPS 2024 (spotlight).

P. Glynn. and **Y. Qu**. On a New Characterization of Harris Recurrence for Markov Chains and Processes. *Mathematics*, 2023.

Preprints

Y. Qu and P. Glynn. A Harris recurrent continuous-time Markov process without wide-sense regenerative structure. arXiv.

Y. Qu, H. Namkoong, and A. Zeevi. A Broader View of Thompson Sampling. arXiv.

Y. Qu, T. Rokicki, and H. Yang. Rubik's Cube Scrambling Requires at Least 26 Random Moves. arXiv.

Y. Qu, R. Kant, Y. Chen, B. Kitts, S. Gultekin, A. Flores, and J. Blanchet. Double Distributionally Robust Bid Shading for First Price Auctions. arXiv.

Y. Qu, J. Blanchet, and P. Glynn. Strong Limit Interchange Property of a Sequence of Markov Processes.

Y. Qu, J. Blanchet, and P. Glynn. Estimating the Convergence Rate to Equilibrium of a Markov Chain via Simulation.

Y. Qu and P. Glynn. Uniform Edgeworth Expansions for Markov Chains with Applications to MCMC Sample Quantiles.

Teaching

At CUHK-Shenzhen, I teach the following course:

STA4001H: Honours Stochastic Processes	2026

At Stanford, I served as a TA for the following MS&E courses:

324: Stochastic Methods in Engineering	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
323: Stochastic Simulation	2020, 2024
321: Stochastic Systems	2023
221: Stochastic Modeling	2020
220: Probabilistic Analysis	2019, 2022
211: Introduction to Optimization	2021
125: Introduction to Applied Statistics	2020
260: Introduction to Operations Management	2020

Awards

Centennial Teaching Assistant Award	2024
Applied Probability Society Best Student Paper Prize	2023
Applied Probability Society Conference Best Poster Award	2023
Dantzig-Lieberman Operations Research Fellowship	2021
Guo Moruo Scholarship	2017

Invited Talks

Deep Learning for Solving Linear Integral Equations Associated with Markov Chains

- INFORMS Annual Meeting 2026

A Broader View of Thompson Sampling (job talk)

- INFORMS Optimization Society Conference 2026
- INFORMS Annual Meeting 2025

Deep Learning for Computing Convergence Rates of Markov Chains

- INFORMS Applied Probability Society Conference 2025

Double Distributionally Robust Bid Shading for First Price Auctions

- INFORMS Annual Meeting 2024

A New Class of Bounds for Convergence of Markov Chains to Equilibrium

- INFORMS Annual Meeting 2023
- INFORMS Applied Probability Society Conference 2023

Estimating Convergence Rates for Markov Chains via Simulation

- INFORMS Annual Meeting 2021

Academic Service

I reviewed papers submitted to the following journals:

European Journal of Operational Research

Mathematics of Operations Research

Annals of Applied Probability

Operations Research